SOC601

Assignment 1 (Fall 2024)

Solution By Vu360



Solution:

Conflict Between Equality and Freedom in Social Policy

1. Conflict Between Equality and Freedom

The principles of equality and freedom clash in social policy when:

1. **Promoting equality limits personal freedoms**: Policies reducing economic disparities may restrict individual choices.
2. **Excessive freedom exacerbates inequality**: Unregulated markets widen gaps in wealth, education and healthcare.
3. **Group rights vs. individual rights**: Protecting group rights (minority, women's) may infringe on individual freedoms.
4. **Resource distribution**: Equal allocation may limit individual freedom to accumulate wealth.
5. **Social welfare vs. personal responsibility**: Comprehensive welfare may undermine personal responsibility.

2. Examples from Pakistani Society

Example	Conflict Description	References
1. **Zakat and Ushr**	Islamic tax system reduces poverty but limits financial freedom.	Govt. of Pakistan. (2020). Zakat and Ushr Ordinance.
2. **Reservations in Education/Employment**	Quotas for underrepresented groups restrict career choices.	Pak. Comm. on Human Rights. (2022). Education Report.
3. **Blasphemy Laws**	Protecting religious sentiments	Human Rights Watch.

Group 1: https://chat.whatsapp.com/F5zhJsjtf5yL4RjDODz1fL
Group 2: https://chat.whatsapp.com/HJYBCFqTTpX3QYAHhOLSa2

Example	Conflict Description	References
	infringes on freedom of expression.	(2020). Pak.'s Blasphemy Laws.
4. **Land Reforms**	Redistribution limits individual property rights.	Khan, A. (2019). Land Reforms in Pak. Journal of Agri. Studies.
5. **Women's Rights/Family Laws**	Laws protecting women's rights conflict with personal/family freedoms.	UN Women Pak. (2020). Women's Rights Report.

Conclusion

Equality and freedom principles inherently conflict in social policy. Pakistani society exemplifies this tension. Policymakers balance fairness and individual rights.

References

1. Government of Pakistan. (2020). *Zakat and Ushr Ordinance*.
2. Pakistan Commission on Human Rights. (2022). *Education Report*.
3. Human Rights Watch. (2020). *Pakistan's Blasphemy Laws*.
4. Khan, A. (2019). Land Reforms in Pakistan. *Journal of Agricultural Studies*, 7(2).
5. UN Women Pakistan. (2020). *Women's Rights Report*.
6. Sen, A. (2000). *Freedom, Rationality and Social Choice*. *Oxford Economic Papers*, 52(4).

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